ent in inference as the word of a reliable person which is the chief distinguishing mark of authority. That is why this *pramāṇa* is called *śabda,* or "word," to indicate clearly its differentia. Here, knowledge is acquired not through any universal connection but solely because of the reliability of the word of a certain person. Praśastapāda, one of the Vaiśeṣika objectors to testimony, in his *bhāṣya* on the *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra,* says, "Words and the rest are also included in inference because they have the same principle," i.e., testimony also functions in the same way as inference. When the Vaiśeṣika system maintains that the knowledge derived from "word" is inferential, what is meant is that words also give knowledge by force of a universal connection just as smoke gives rise to the knowledge of fire.[6] Similarly, the Buddhist logician Diṅnāga in his *Pramāṇa-samuccaya* asks, "What is the significance of the credible word? Does it mean that the person who spoke the word is credible or that the fact he averred is credible?"[7] In either case, the means of knowledge is either inference or perception. We have learned from experience that as a general rule the statements of reliable persons are true, and we apply this experience to the case of the particular statement. To this the Nyāya reply is that the opponent has not understood the meaning of cognition by verbal indication, and that, as explained above, he means by *pramāṇa* quite another thing. When we consider that the Naiyāyika and the Bauddha both hold that the means of knowledge do not carry their own validity with them but it must be separately established from some other source, it is difficult to understand how the Bauddhas can refuse to admit "word" as a separate *pramāṇa.* This confusion is due to the fact that, while the Nyāya is speaking of "word" as a psychological cause of knowledge, the Bauddha is speaking of knowledge as true or false. "Word" *(śabda)* is thus to be regarded as quite an independent source of knowledge, which is not covered under any one of the other sources of knowledge.

The second objection to authority points out the fact that testimony is often false and contradictory. It therefore cannot be accepted as valid. This argument of the opponents of authority is regarded as based on pure prejudice, for it is obvious that this defect is no peculiarity of authority alone, but is common to perception, inference, and any other source of knowledge which may be regarded as valid. Our perceptions, inferences, and analogies can all be wrong and contradictory and do often turn out to be so when they stand in need of correction, but no one refuses to recognize them on that account as valid means of knowledge. Neither perception, nor inference, nor any other source of